CERNO GLOBUS

FIELD INTELLIGENCE

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Build & Renovate

Roofing · Restoration · Garage Door · Exteriors · General Contracting · Home Building

Six trades, one publication. Every item is something that moves a number on your P&L, changes what you must do by law, or changes what parts and labor cost you.

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BACKGROUND SIGNAL
The fraud that reads your invoices before it sends one

Read it online
This issue, and every one before it

SUPPLY

Owens Corning's roofing sales fell 16% to $1,042 million in the third quarter, and it guides fourth-quarter industry shipments down in the high teens as distributors destock.

Owens Corning reported November 4 that third-quarter roofing sales were $1,042 million, down 16% from $1,240 million. Roofing EBITDA was $299 million, a 29% margin, down from 34%. Company sales fell 7% to $2,489 million, and it booked $476 million of non-cash impairment charges on its Doors business.

U.S. ARMA shipments fell 13% in the quarter, which management called "weaker than anticipated." Management said weather demand has fallen below historical averages "now for 2 years in a row," and that no Atlantic hurricanes made landfall during the quarter. The release cites "a second consecutive year of weak storm activity."

Distributors are "starting to destock relative to a smaller market opportunity," and management expects "a heavier destocking this Q4 even versus last Q4." Fourth-quarter roofing revenue is guided down high single digits, ARMA shipments "down in the high teens," and EBITDA margin 18% to 20%. For the full year, management agreed with an analyst's math putting ARMA down about 10%.

Management said pricing is expected to be relatively flat year over year in the fourth quarter. It would consider a spring price increase if inflation stays high and demand is expected to improve, and said 2027 begins with "no storm carryover." Material and transportation inflation outran its slightly positive third-quarter pricing.

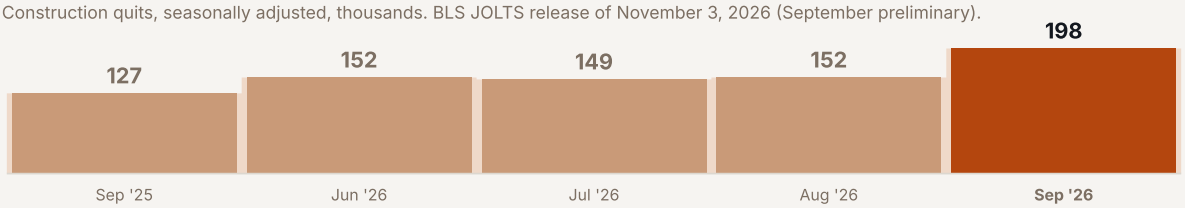
What to do about it: Call your roofing distributor this week and get three answers in writing: what Owens Corning inventory it holds and expects to destock in the fourth quarter, how long its price quotes stay valid, and whether any price hold runs through your first-quarter bids. Do not pre-buy shingles beyond signed jobs; the company's own guidance has fourth-quarter pricing flat, with a spring increase tied to high inflation, which it says it is in, and better demand. If storm work is a large share of your revenue, count the retail reroof proposals you can close before January and set a cash floor for another weak storm year. Put a 30-day price-validity date on every proposal.

Owens Corning Q3 2026 results release (Nov 4) · Owens Corning Q3 2026 earnings call transcript (Nov 4)

INFOGRAPHIC 1 / CONSTRUCTION QUITS

Construction quits reached 198,000 in September, the highest of the five readings shown and up from 127,000 a year earlier.

Construction quits, seasonally adjusted, thousands. BLS JOLTS release of November 3, 2026 (September preliminary).



BLS counts 198,000 construction quits in September, a 2.4% rate, against 152,000 in each of June and August and 127,000 in September 2025. Layoffs and discharges fell to 138,000 from 194,000 a year earlier. The first reading is a year back, so the chart skips July 2025 to May 2026. Check your own quit count against these rates before wage reviews. BLS JOLTS release, September 2026 (Nov 3)

ROOFING

TWO ITEMS

DEMAND

Carlisle's Construction Materials revenue rose 8% to $1.1 billion in the third quarter, and its CEO said re-roofing has grown steadily while the outlook assumes no new-construction recovery.

Why it matters: Carlisle reported October 28 that Construction Materials revenue rose 8% (9% organic) to $1,084.9 million, tempered by soft commercial new construction, and Weatherproofing Technologies rose 9% to $379 million. Its CEO said, "Re-roofing has grown steadily since we launched Vision 2030." Raw material and freight inflation outpaced pricing, and Construction Materials adjusted EBITDA margin fell 200 basis points to 28.2%. Carlisle's outlook "does not assume a near-term recovery in new construction markets." Ask your distributor what price protection covers spring bids, and keep reroof proposals priced to current material cost.

Carlisle Q3 2026 results, Business Wire (Oct 28)

SUPPLY

CPSC announced November 5 a recall of about 3,662,000 Little Giant ladders with Rapid Locks, sold from December 2015 through October 2026 for about $100 to $1,000, after 19 injury reports.

Why it matters: The ladders can suddenly retract if the Rapid Locks are not fully engaged. CPSC lists 25 reports of retraction, 19 with injuries, three of them head injuries, and 39 reports of locks not working properly. Models: Adjustable Fortress 2.0, Conquest 2.0, Dark Horse 2.0, Epic, King Kombo XT, Leveler, MegaLite, MegaLite+, Multi, Quantum and Vector; ladders with an orange QC sticker above a lock are excluded. Remedy is a repair kit with warning labels, then a replacement or refund if a lock still fails; refunds within 12 months of purchase are full price. Pull every Little Giant from trucks and the shop today, check for the sticker, and log the date you order kits.

CPSC: Little Giant ladder recall 27-067 (Nov 5)

RESTORATION

TWO ITEMS

INSURANCE

Florida's insurance regulator told property insurers on November 3 to file cumulative Hurricane Isaias claims data by noon November 6, after an earlier filing deadline of October 27.

Why it matters: The Office of Insurance Regulation's November 3 notice requires every insurer authorized for Florida fire, homeowners, private flood and related lines to submit the simplified 2026 Catastrophe Reporting Form by 12 p.m. ET Friday, November 6. Reporting is cumulative and must include all claims as of the reporting date; an October 23 notice set the same filing for October 27. If you hold open Isaias estimates or supplements, send written follow-ups to each adjuster this week and record claim numbers and dates.

Florida OIR notice: Isaias catastrophe reporting (Nov 3) · Florida OIR notice: Isaias catastrophe reporting (Oct 23)

MONEY

RIA said October 22 that Verisk plans to add a new material handling line item at a $0 "Each" unit to its November 1 Xactimate price lists, so estimators enter a flat dollar amount.

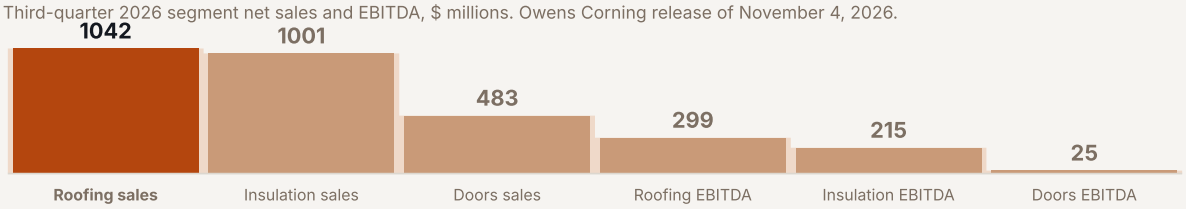
Why it matters: RIA said October 22 that Verisk plans to add the line item to the U.S. and Canada price lists effective November 1 with a $0 "Each" unit, so the estimator would enter a flat amount for applicable jobs. It is not a preset reimbursement rate: its published definition governs use, and supporting documentation should explain the added work without duplicating costs already in the estimate. RIA says the change does not resolve price availability, payment terms or fulfillment responsibility. On your next estimate, add the line with a written scope, purchase receipts and time logs, and record whether the carrier pays or cuts it.

R&R: RIA helps deliver Xactimate line item (Oct 22)

INFOGRAPHIC 2 / OWENS CORNING Q3

Owens Corning's roofing segment sold $1,042 million in the third quarter, down 16%, and earned $299 million of EBITDA.

Third-quarter 2026 segment net sales and EBITDA, $ millions. Owens Corning release of November 4, 2026.



Roofing sales were $1,042 million, down 16% from $1,240 million, and roofing EBITDA of $299 million was a 29% margin, down from 34%. Insulation sales rose 6% to $1,001 million. Doors earned $25 million on $483 million of sales. Owens Corning Q3 2026 results release (Nov 4)

GARAGE DOOR

TWO ITEMS

REGULATION

CPSC's direct final rule, published October 30, adopts UL 325 Seventh Edition for residential garage door operators and adds battery-powered units, effective 60 days after publication unless adverse comments arrive.

Why it matters: The rule (16 CFR Part 1211) updates the mandatory standard to UL 325:2025, revised September 15, 2025. Battery-powered operators, including battery backup systems, must operate normally under the cited paragraphs or be rendered inoperative, tested on a full battery and again after discharge. TUV lists an effective date of December 29, 2026 and comments by November 30; CPSC withdraws the affected part if a significant adverse comment arrives. Ask each operator supplier for written confirmation that current models, including battery backups, meet the Seventh Edition before you stock for January.

Federal Register public inspection: CPSC GDO rule · TUV: UL 325 update for garage door operators

REGULATION

CPSC warned October 29 consumers to stop using about 2,610 ASONPAO Ghost Controls gate opener remote transmitters because their lithium coin batteries are easily accessed by children.

Why it matters: CPSC's October 29 warning covers gate opener remote transmitters whose coin batteries children can reach, an ingestion hazard. The warning's title says they violate the mandatory standard for consumer products with coin batteries. About 2,610 units are covered, and CPSC lists a warning, not a recall. Dealers and installers who sell or program replacement remotes should pull any ASONPAO or Ghost Controls units from stock, ask every remote supplier for written coin-battery compliance, and keep sale records in case a customer calls.

CPSC recalls and warnings list (Oct 22 - Nov 5)

EXTERIORS

TWO ITEMS

DEMAND

Trex's third-quarter net sales rose 26.0% to $360 million, but about $30 million was initial distribution load-in and gross margin fell to 36.0% from 40.5%.

Why it matters: Trex reported November 4 net sales of $360 million against $285 million a year earlier, with roughly $30 million from initial distribution load-in. It called growth "overwhelmingly volume-driven, with minimal benefit from pricing," said overall channel inventory was comparable to last year, and described the broader market as "mixed." It raised 2026 net sales guidance to $1,296 million to $1,306 million and guided fourth-quarter sales to $175 million to $185 million. Ask your distributor about January pricing and what product is on hand before you quote spring decks and railings.

Trex Q3 2026 results, Business Wire (Nov 4)

MONEY

A November 3 roundup of manufacturer letters lists TimberTech decking and railing up 3% to 4% on January 1, TCC Materials stucco and mortar up 5% to 10%, and James Hardie soffit and trim up 2% on January 4.

Why it matters: The ContractorPlus roundup, posted November 3, lists TimberTech (AZEK) decking and railing up 3% to 4% effective January 1, 2027, and TCC Materials mortar, concrete mixes, grout and stucco up 5% to 10% the same day. James Hardie soffit and trim rises 2% on January 4. TCC says price protection will not be available beyond its effective date. Ask your distributor for each letter in writing, price any job that ships after January 1 at the new cost, and put a validity date on every exterior quote.

ContractorPlus: building material price increases

GENERAL CONTRACTING

TWO ITEMS

LABOR

Construction job openings rose to 298,000 in September and quits jumped to 198,000, a 2.4% quit rate against 1.5% a year earlier, BLS reported November 3.

Why it matters: BLS's JOLTS release of November 3 puts construction openings at 298,000 in September, up 36,000 from August and 92,000 from September 2025. Quits were 198,000, up from 152,000 in August and 127,000 a year earlier. Hires were 356,000 (4.3%), and layoffs and discharges 138,000 (1.6%) against 194,000 (2.3%) a year earlier. September figures are preliminary. Pull your own 2026 turnover, price a retention raise for your best crew leads against the cost of replacing them, and decide it before a competitor makes an offer.

BLS JOLTS release, September 2026 (Nov 3) · NAHB Eye on Housing: construction job openings

INSURANCE

NRCA reported November 3 that a Connecticut roofing owner was arrested on a workers' compensation fraud charge after his policy premium rose from $1,340 to $12,401 a year following an August 2024 update.

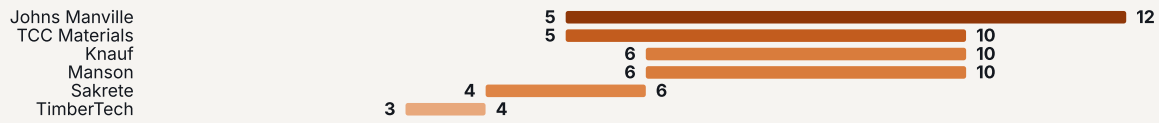
Why it matters: NRCA, citing CT Insider and the arrest warrant, says the owner of LA Roofing LLC, a non-member, is charged with giving false or misleading employee counts from October 19, 2023 to August 15, 2024, with roofing workers listed as salespeople or clerical staff. A $60,600 Labor Department penalty was reduced to $25,000, and a second $3,600 penalty followed in August 2024. Of eight workers interviewed at one site, all said they worked for the firm and seven said they were paid in cash. A plea hearing is set for December 2. Confirm every worker, including subcontractor crews, sits under the right class code, and collect current certificates of insurance this week.

NRCA: roofing contractor charged with comp fraud (Nov 3)

INFOGRAPHIC 3 / JANUARY PRICE LETTERS

Six January 2027 increases from the roundup run from 3% to 12%, and Johns Manville's 5% to 12% is the widest of the six.

Low and high percent increase in manufacturer letters, effective January 1 to 22, 2027. ContractorPlus roundup posted November 3, 2026.



Johns Manville insulation shows 5% to 12% from January 11, TCC mortar and stucco 5% to 10% from January 1, Knauf and Manson 6% to 10% from January 22, Sakrete 4% to 6% from January 4 and TimberTech 3% to 4% from January 1. TCC says price protection ends on its effective date. Ask distributors for the letters and price spring bids at the new cost. ContractorPlus: building material price increases

HOME BUILDING

TWO ITEMS

SUPPLY

Builders FirstSource's third-quarter net sales fell 2.2% to $3.9 billion with core organic single-family sales down 6.2%, and its guidance assumes single-family starts down mid- to high-single digits.

Why it matters: The building-products supplier reported October 29 core organic single-family sales down 6.2%, multifamily up 2.0% and repair and remodel up 0.3%. Gross margin was 27.8%, down 260 basis points, and adjusted EBITDA fell 28.3% to $311.1 million. It narrowed 2026 guidance to net sales of $14.2 billion to $14.6 billion, assuming single-family starts in its geographies down mid- to high-single digits, repair and remodel down 1%, and commodity prices of $390 to $410 per thousand board feet. Ask your supplier for a written price hold on framing packages through your next closings.

Builders FirstSource Q3 2026 results (Oct 29)

DEMAND

Private residential construction spending fell 5.5% in September to an $848.8 billion annual rate, 8.9% below a year earlier, with improvements down 13.0% in the month and 18.0% on the year.

Why it matters: NAHB's November 2 analysis of the Census Bureau's September construction spending report puts private residential spending at $848.8 billion, seasonally adjusted annual rate. Single-family spending was unchanged from August and down 2.4% from a year earlier. Total construction spending fell 1.9% in September against an expected 0.3% gain, after August was revised up to 2.0%, and was down 2.7% from a year earlier. Compare your own September signed contracts and draws with these rates before you set winter purchasing and labor.

NAHB Eye on Housing: private residential spending · GV Wire: US construction spending tumbles in September

THE BACKGROUND SIGNAL

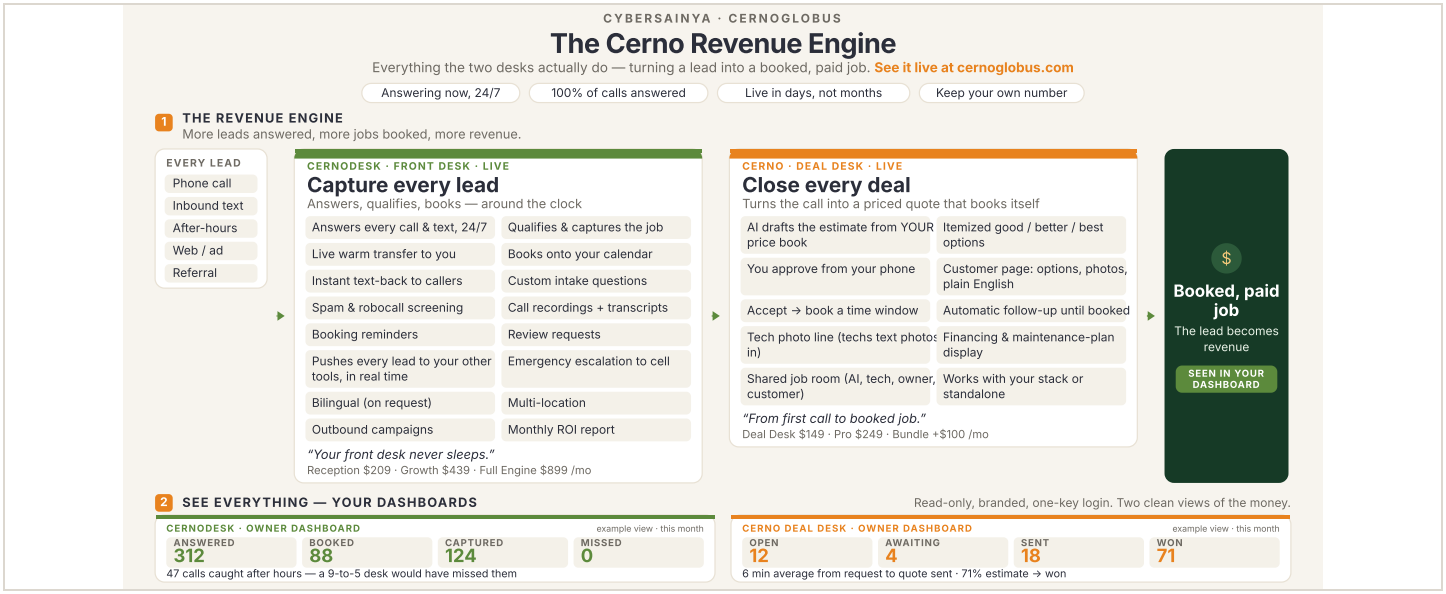
The fraud that reads your invoices before it sends one

The FBI's Internet Crime Complaint Center took 24,768 business email compromise reports in 2025, with losses of $3.05 billion — a record, after dipping to $2.77 billion in 2024 from $2.95 billion in 2023. Across all internet crime it logged 1,008,597 complaints and $20.88 billion in losses. Reported cases only, so read it as a floor.

Business email compromise, not ransomware, is the one that should concern a builder or remodeler. Someone gets into a mailbox, reads until they understand how you invoice and who pays you, then sends a real-looking progress billing with different bank details. No malware, no warning — just a payment that never arrives and an argument about who eats it. A trade that emails bids, change orders and supplier invoices all day is the shape this is built for. The quieter number is adoption: under 20% of firms with fewer than 20 staff use AI at all.

What to do about it: You don't need a security program. You need multi-factor authentication on email and your accounting login, and one rule everybody follows: nobody changes bank details on the strength of an email or a call — you ring the number you already had on file and confirm. That covers most of it, and costs nothing. The part it doesn't — how the systems are set up — is the day job of our parent company, CyberSainya.

FBI Internet Crime Complaint Center, 2025 Internet Crime Report — reported cases only, rounded from $2,946,830,270, $2,770,151,146 and $3,046,598,558. U.S. Census Bureau, Business Trends and Outlook Survey, May 3, 2026.



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